



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD ADDITIVE DETAILS

Sodium ascorbate (301)

Functional Classes

- Antioxidant
- Flour treatment agent

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CSV (Tables)

GSFA Provisions for Sodium ascorbate

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 14.1.5	Coffee, coffee substitutes, tea, herbal infusions, and other hot cereal and grain beverages, excluding cocoa	GMP	 Note 160
 13.2	Complementary foods for infants and young children	500 mg/kg	 Note 320  Note 317  Note 319  Note 65
 14.1.2.3	Concentrates for fruit juice	GMP	 Note 127
 14.1.3.3	Concentrates for fruit nectar	GMP	 Note 127
 06.4.2	Dried pastas and noodles and like products	200 mg/kg	 Note 256
 04.2.2.7	Fermented vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera) and seaweed products, excluding fermented soybean products of food categories 06.8.6, 06.8.7, 12.9.1, 12.9.2.1 and 12.9.2.3	GMP	 Note XS294
 06.2.1	Flours	300 mg/kg	 Note 170
 13.1.2	Follow-up formulae	50 mg/kg	 Note 551  Note 581  Note 316  Note 317  Note 381  Note 315
 13.1.3	Formulae for special medical purposes for infants	75 mg/kg	 Note 551  Note 83  Note 381  Note 591
 08.1.2	Fresh meat, poultry, and game, comminuted	GMP	 Note 281
 09.1.2	Fresh mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms	GMP	 Note XS312  Note 390  Note XS315
 06.4.1	Fresh pastas and noodles and like products	GMP	
 14.1.2.1	Fruit juice	GMP	
 14.1.3.1	Fruit nectar	GMP	
 13.1.1	Infant formulae	75 mg/kg	 Note 551  Note 83  Note 381  Note 591

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 01.5.1	Milk powder and cream powder (plain)	GMP	 Note 317  Note 545  Note XS290
 01.1.2	Other fluid milk (plain)	GMP	 Note 410
 04.1.1.3	Peeled or cut fresh fruit	GMP	
 04.2.1.3	Peeled, cut or shredded fresh vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweeds, and nuts and seeds	GMP	
 09.2	Processed fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms	GMP	 Note XS191  Note XS92  Note XS312  Note XS244  Note XS167  Note 307  Note 437  Note XS189  Note XS222  Note XS315  Note XS236  Note 392
 12.1.2	Salt Substitutes	GMP	 Note 314

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

GSFA Table 3 Provisions

Sodium ascorbate is a food additive that is included in **Table 3**, and as such may be used in the following foods under the conditions of good manufacturing practices (GMP) as outlined in the Preamble of the Codex GSFA. Although not listed below, Sodium ascorbate could also be used in heat-treated butter milk of food category 01.1.1 and spices of food category 12.2.1. Note that food categories listed in the **Annex to Table 3** were excluded accordingly. **Sodium ascorbate** is acceptable in foods conforming to the following commodity standards: CS 88-1981, CS 89-1981, CS 96-1981, CS 97-1981, CS 98-1981, CS 251-2006, CS 275-1973.

Sodium ascorbate is a: Antioxidant

Any Antioxidant listed in Table 3 can be acceptable for use in all products conforming to CS 117-1981, CS 291-2010, CS 319-2015 (canned mangoes only), CS 256-2007, CS 306-2011.

Number	Food Category
 01.1.4	Flavoured fluid milk drinks
 01.3	Condensed milk and analogues (plain)
 01.4.3	Clotted cream (plain)
 01.4.4	Cream analogues
 01.5	Milk powder and cream powder and powder analogues (plain)
 01.6.1	Unripened cheese
 01.6.2	Ripened cheese
 01.6.4	Processed cheese
 01.6.5	Cheese analogues
 01.7	Dairy-based desserts (e.g. pudding, fruit or flavoured yoghurt)
 01.8.1	Liquid whey and whey products, excluding whey cheeses
 02.2.2	Fat spreads, dairy fat spreads and blended spreads
 02.3	Fat emulsions mainly of type oil-in-water, including mixed and/or flavoured products based on fat emulsions
 02.4	Fat-based desserts excluding dairy-based dessert products of food category 01.7
 03.0	Edible ices, including sherbet and sorbet
 04.1.2	Processed fruit
 04.2.2.2	Dried vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweeds, and nuts and seeds
 04.2.2.3	Vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds in vinegar, oil, brine, or soybean sauce

Number ▼	Food Category ▼
 04.2.2.4	Canned or bottled (pasteurized) or retort pouch vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds
 04.2.2.5	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed purees and spreads (e.g., peanut butter)
 04.2.2.6	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed pulps and preparations (e.g. vegetable desserts and sauces, candied vegetables) other than food category 04.2.2.5
 04.2.2.8	Cooked or fried vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds
 05.0	Confectionery
 06.3	Breakfast cereals, including rolled oats
 06.4.3	Pre-cooked pastas and noodles and like products
 06.5	Cereal and starch based desserts (e.g. rice pudding, tapioca pudding)
 06.6	Batters (e.g. for breading or batters for fish or poultry)
 06.7	Pre-cooked or processed rice products, including rice cakes (Oriental type only)
 06.8	Soybean products (excluding soybean-based seasonings and condiments of food category 12.9)
 07.0	Bakery wares
 08.2	Processed meat, poultry, and game products in whole pieces or cuts
 08.3	Processed comminuted meat, poultry, and game products
 08.4	Edible casings (e.g. sausage casings)
 09.3	Semi-preserved fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms
 09.4	Fully preserved, including canned or fermented fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms
 10.2.3	Dried and/or heat coagulated egg products
 10.3	Preserved eggs, including alkaline, salted, and canned eggs
 10.4	Egg-based desserts (e.g. custard)
 11.6	Table-top sweeteners, including those containing high-intensity sweeteners
 12.2.2	Seasonings and condiments
 12.3	Vinegars
 12.4	Mustards
 12.5	Soups and broths
 12.6	Sauces and like products
 12.7	Salads (e.g. macaroni salad, potato salad) and sandwich spreads excluding cocoa- and nut-based spreads of food categories 04.2.2.5 and 05.1.3
 12.8	Yeast and like products
 12.9	Soybean-based seasonings and condiments
 12.10	Protein products other than from soybeans
 13.3	Dietetic foods intended for special medical purposes (excluding products of food category 13.1)
 13.4	Dietetic formulae for slimming purposes and weight reduction
13.5	Dietetic foods (e.g. supplementary foods for dietary use) excluding products of food categories 13.1 - 13.4 and 13.6
13.6	Food supplements
14.1.4	Water-based flavoured drinks, including "sport," "energy," or "electrolyte" drinks and particulated drinks
14.2.1	Beer and malt beverages
14.2.2	Cider and perry
14.2.4	Wines (other than grape)
14.2.5	Mead
14.2.6	Distilled spirituous beverages containing more than 15% alcohol
14.2.7	Aromatized alcoholic beverages (e.g. beer, wine and spirituous cooler-type beverages, low alcoholic refreshers)
15.0	Ready-to-eat savouries

Number ▾	Food Category ▾
 16.0	Prepared foods

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

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